

Chapter 2 — “Why Do We Still Need Human Developers?”

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This is the question. Every other AI question in your interview is a variant of this one. Master this chapter and 60% of the interview is already won.

What you’ll learn

- The **5 different ways** this question gets asked, and how to recognize each one in real time.
- The **7-pillar answer framework** — a complete, defensible response built on layered evidence.
- **Real-world cases** — short, memorable stories where humans saved AI-generated work, that you can adapt as your own.

By the end of the chapter, you will be able to deliver a 90-second answer to *any* phrasing of this question that is:

- **Honest** — no dismissal of AI’s real strengths.
- **Confident** — no defensiveness about your own role.
- **Concrete** — backed by examples, not slogans.
- **Memorable** — structured the way the interviewer wants to remember it for the hiring committee.

Lessons

1. **01-the-five-framings.md** — The five real shapes this question takes. The hostile version, the curious version, the technical version, the business version, and the ex-

istential version. Each gets a different opening sentence.

2. **02-the-seven-pillars.md** – The complete answer framework. Seven pillars of human contribution that AI does not credibly threaten in the next 5 years. Every pillar has a soundbite and an example.
3. **03-real-world-cases.md** – Eight memorable stories drawn from real engineering: bugs AI introduced, decisions AI couldn't make, work AI couldn't do at all. Adapt one or two as your own.

How long it should take

- 45 min reading per lesson.
- 30 min after each lesson rehearsing aloud.
- ~4 hours total – but this is the chapter to budget more time for. **Re-read it before any AI-context interview.**

Why this chapter is the centerpiece

Most candidates tense up when asked “Why are you still needed?” – they hear it as an attack. It usually isn't. The interviewer is asking because:

1. They themselves are wrestling with it (their own job is changing).
2. Their hiring manager asked them to ask it.
3. They want to know if you've thought about it (versus being naive).

A confident, structured answer **lowers the temperature in the room**. The interviewer relaxes. The follow-up questions become friendlier. **You set the tone for the rest of the interview.**

Before you start

You should have:

- Completed Chapter 1 (the vocabulary you'll use here).
- A pen and notebook for the answer-rehearsal exercises.
- 90 minutes of uninterrupted time for at least one of the lessons.

Open **01-the-five-framings.md**.